Bureau of
FAR EASTERN AFFAIRS
OCT 1 1 1954
ASSISTANT SECRETARY
Department of State

#3776

Reference is Interim

In reply refer to
CA 7944.00/9-2954

Dear Senator Saltonstall:

I refer to your communication of September 29, 1954, enclosing a letter from Mr. John M. Whitcomb, of Dedham, Massachusetts, dated September 22, in which Mr. Whitcomb transmits an editorial from the "Christian Science Monitor" regarding the defense of Quemoy and expresses concern over "our involvements in Formosan affairs".

Secretary of State Dulles stated the United States position toward Quemoy and other off-shore islands in a press conference on August 24, 1954, when he said:

> "Well, the basic instruction is to defend the Island of Formosa. Now, there are a number of islands held by the Nationalists which lie in between Formosa and the mainland, and the defense of which may from a military standpoint be so intimately connected with the defense of Formosa that the military would be justified in concluding that the defense of Formosa comprehended a defense of those islands. That would be primarily a military decision. Many of those islands, Pescadores and some of the others, have, I believe, radar equipment and early-warning devices upon them which are related to the defense of Formosa."

Beyond that there has been no official statement as to what the United States will or will not do in the event of a Chinese Communist attack against islands lying off the China coast held by the forces of the Republic of China. Certainly the United States Government has no intention, as the "Christian Science Monitor" editorial suggests, of using the hostilities around Quemoy as a pretext for participating in an invasion of the China mainland.

The

The Honorable
Leverett Saltonstall,
United States Senate.

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The United States does not support the proposal that Formosa be placed under United Nations trusteeship. One reason for this stand is that we recognize the Government of the Republic of China as the legitimate government of China, able and entitled to govern independently of United Nations or any other supervision, and as the Government to which, by the terms of the Cairo Declaration, Formosa was to be restored.

Another reason is that as the seat of the Chinese Government Formosa serves as a rallying point for freedom-loving Chinese, for those overseas as well as for those suffering under Communism on the mainland.

A third reason is that the existence of a free China makes possible the continued denial of international prestige to the Chinese Communist regime. Formosa is also important to free world defenses in the Far East, forming an important link in the chain of free countries stretching from Japan down through the Philippines. A United Nations trusteeship over Formosa would at least in a large measure automatically cancel all these present advantages.

In any event the United Nations trusteeship proposal is not realistic since a trusteeship could only be imposed and maintained by the employment of force on a large scale. The proposal has been vociferously denounced both by the Government of the Republic of China itself as well as by its mortal enemy, the Chinese Communist regime.

I am returning Mr. Whitcomb's letter with enclosure as you requested.

Sincerely yours,

For the Secretary of State:

Ben H. Brown, Jr.
Acting Assistant Secretary

Enclosures:

From Mr. Whitcomb,
September 22, 1954, with enclosure.

[illegible]
10/4/54

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